



DEALER BEST PRACTICE SERIES

ANALYZER™ Recalculation Process
Improves Projection Accuracy

Application Maintenance Site Management Component Rebuild Safety **MARC Management**

TM

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1.0 Introduction

The ANALYZER™ Recalculation Process Best Practice deals with MARC Management.

Current users of Analyzer have communicated confusion regarding the Analyzer recalculation process and how it differs based on the respective dealer's Financial Year-End. Failure to use the proper recalculation process will have a detrimental impact to Analyzer's ability to accurately forecast the financial/performance health of contracts as well as provide accurate reporting of historical activity.

By following the recommendations detailed in the Analyzer Recalculation Process Best Practice, users can be confident that all current work order and billing information is accounted for in the projection calculations as well as historical functionality in Analyzer. The overall benefit is increased accuracy of Analyzer projections.

2.0 Best Practice Description

The recommended process for recalculating Analyzer is communicated and put into practice during Analyzer training classes. However, not all training participants will immediately begin using Analyzer or will be regular users of the tool, resulting in confusion as to what recalculation date to use during the recalculation process.

The Analyzer Recalculation Process Best Practice, provides the user with a recommended process for selecting the appropriate recalculation date as well as actually recalculating Analyzer.

1) Determine the suggested Recalculation Date

a) Determining the Latest Invoice Period

- ⇒ Navigate to the View Data Tables screen and double-click Contract Cost under the Transaction Data heading.
- ⇒ Use the scroll bar at the bottom of the screen until the Invoice Period column is visible. Select (highlight) the Invoice Period column and select  (Sort Descending).
- ⇒ The first date (yyyymm) in the Invoice Period column represents the latest period work orders were invoiced to the customer and corresponds to the dealer's accounting system. This period does not represent the date when the work order was opened.

NOTE: Any work order in Analyzer without an Invoice Period value in the Contract Cost Table is considered Work In Process (WIP) and is included in the Analyzer projection regardless of the recalculation date used.

b) Determining Analyzer's Financial Year-End

- ⇒ In order to determine the required recalculation date, first confirm the Dealer Data File's financial year-end. This is accomplished by navigating to the Administration switchboard

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of Analyzer and selecting Set Financial Dates. The file's year-end month is displayed at the top.

(1) Financial Year-End is December (If Financial Year-End is not December, please skip to (2) Financial Year-End other than December)

(a) If the Dealer Data File's financial year-end is December, the Recalculation Date is determined using the following methodology.

- Dealer Data File Year-End = **December**
- ContractCost Table Invoice Period column latest period = **200605**
- Recalculation Date: First of the month following the Invoice Period Month

(b) Based on the information provided above, the suggested recalculation date is June 1, 2005 (First of the month following the Invoice Period Month). Using this date will ensure Analyzer includes all work orders and customer billings through June 1, 2005 in the recalculation process.

(2) Financial Year-End other than December

(a) If the Dealer Data File is based on a financial year-end other than December, the latest Invoice Period must be converted back to the equivalent calendar date using the methodology illustrated below.

- Dealer Data File Year-End = **June**
- ContractCost Table Invoice Period column latest period = **200704**
- Recalculation Date: First of the month following the Invoice Period Month converted to the corresponding Calendar Date

(b) Navigate to the Administration switchboard of Analyzer and select Set Financial Dates.

(c) Scroll down the Financial Date Column until you reach the date value equal to the ContractCost Table Invoice Period latest period value.

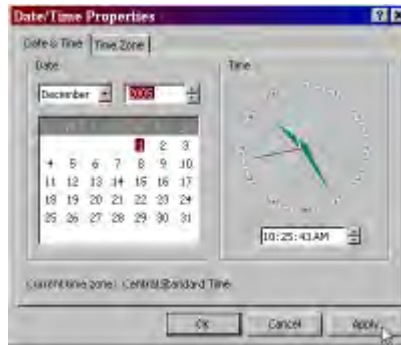
(d) Using the above ContractCost Table Invoice Period column latest period example, scroll down until you reach 200704. The corresponding Calendar Date field value is 200610.

(e) The recommended Recalculation date is November 1, 2006 (First of the month following the Invoice Period Month converted to the corresponding Calendar Date). Using this date will ensure Analyzer includes all work orders and customer billings through November 1, 2006 in the recalculation process.

2) Resetting the System Clock

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- a) Now that the Recalculation Date is known, reset your computer's system clock to the suggested recalculation date.



3) Recalculate Analyzer

- a) From the main Analyzer switchboard select Recalculate Analyzer and click OK to the pop-up message.
- b) When the Analyzer Recalculation Finished screen is displayed, select CLOSE.
- c) Analyzer Recalculation is now complete.

3.0 Implementation Steps

1. In order to successfully implement this Best Practice, the critical assumption is that all users have received basic Analyzer user training either internally or from Caterpillar.
2. In addition, it is recommended that users have, at a minimum, Level 1 Microsoft Access training and are comfortable navigating within an Access database/tables.

4.0 Benefits

- Reduce user confusion when the need to recalculate Analyzer presents itself
- Provide a globally consistent Analyzer recalculation process. (Dealers that have a Financial Year-End other than December will find this Best Practice especially useful).

5.0 Resources Required

1. Full implementation of Analyzer 1.6W is required.
2. MS Access 2000 (full version)
3. Having trained Analyzer users is critical to the success of this process. Users should have received some form of basic Analyzer training either internally or through Caterpillar.
4. In addition, users should have a basic understanding of Microsoft Access (MS Access 2000 Level 1).

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6.0 Supporting Attachments / References

[ANALYZER Recalculation Procedure.doc](#) - clicking on the "Attachments" tab in this Adobe electronic file will open this Microsoft Word document.

7.0 Related Best Practices

[0906-3.3-1010](#) - *Analyzer Validation Process*
[1006-3.3-1031](#) - *Managing Historical "Un-Cleansed" Work Orders in ANALYZER*

8.0 Acknowledgements

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